

Objects First with JAVA

A Practical Introduction using BlueJ

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Course Contents

- Introduction to object-oriented programming...
- ...with a strong software engineering foundation...
- ...aimed at producing and maintaining large, high-quality software systems.

Terminology

inheritance responsibility-driven design

iterator encapsulation

abstraction overriding coupling

cohesion interface

javadoc class

collection class mutator

stream lambda

instance polymorphic method call

Goals

- Sound knowledge of programming principles
- Sound knowledge of object-orientation
- Able to implement a small software system in Java

Book

David J. Barnes & Michael Kölling

Objects First with Java

A Practical Introduction using BlueJ

7th edition, Pearson Education, 2025

Overview

- Objects and classes
- Understanding class definitions
- Object interaction
- Grouping objects
- Functional programming style
- More sophisticated behavior - libraries
- Designing classes
- Teamwork

Overview

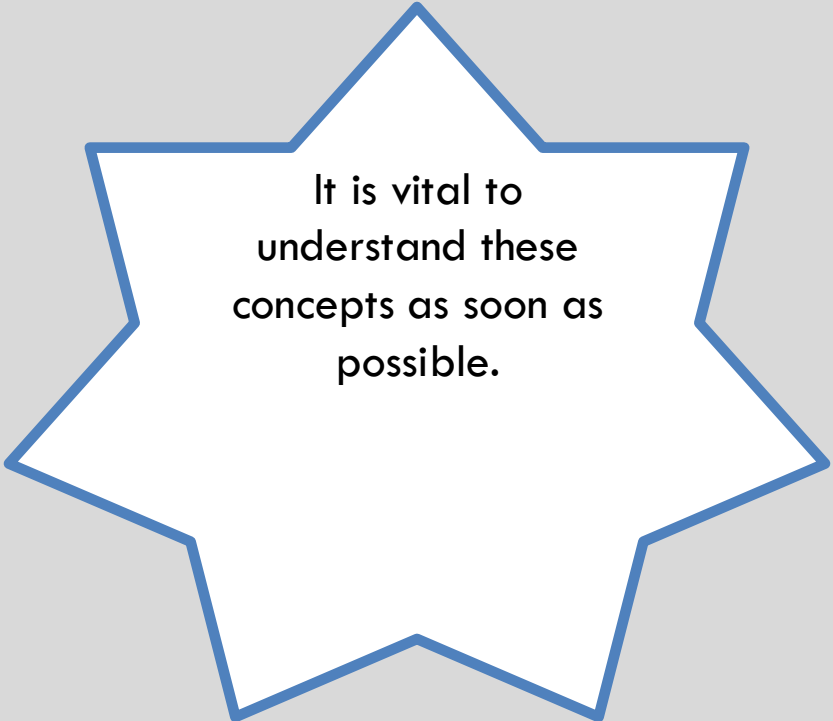
- Data-oriented classes
- A brief history of Java
- Handling errors
- Designing applications

Classes and objects

- Fundamental to much of the early parts of this course.
- Class: category or type of ‘thing’. Like a template or blueprint.
- Object: belongs to a particular class and has individual characteristics.
- Explore through BlueJ ...

Fundamental concepts

- object
- class
- method
- parameter
- data type



It is vital to
understand these
concepts as soon as
possible.

Classes and Objects

- A class
 - represents all similar objects of a kind (example: “car”)
- objects
 - represent ‘things’ from the real world, or from some problem domain;
 - example: “that red car in the parking lot”.

Methods and Parameters

- Objects have operations which can be invoked (Java calls them *methods*).
- Methods may have parameters to receive additional information needed to execute.
 - Parameters introduce variation into the effect of method calls.

Other observations

- Many distinct ***instances*** can be created from a single class.
- An object has ***attributes***: values stored in ***fields***.
- The class defines what fields an object has, but each object stores its own set of values (the ***state*** of the object).

State

circle1 : Circle

private int diameter	68
private int xPosition	230
private int yPosition	130
private String color	"blue"
private boolean isVisible	true

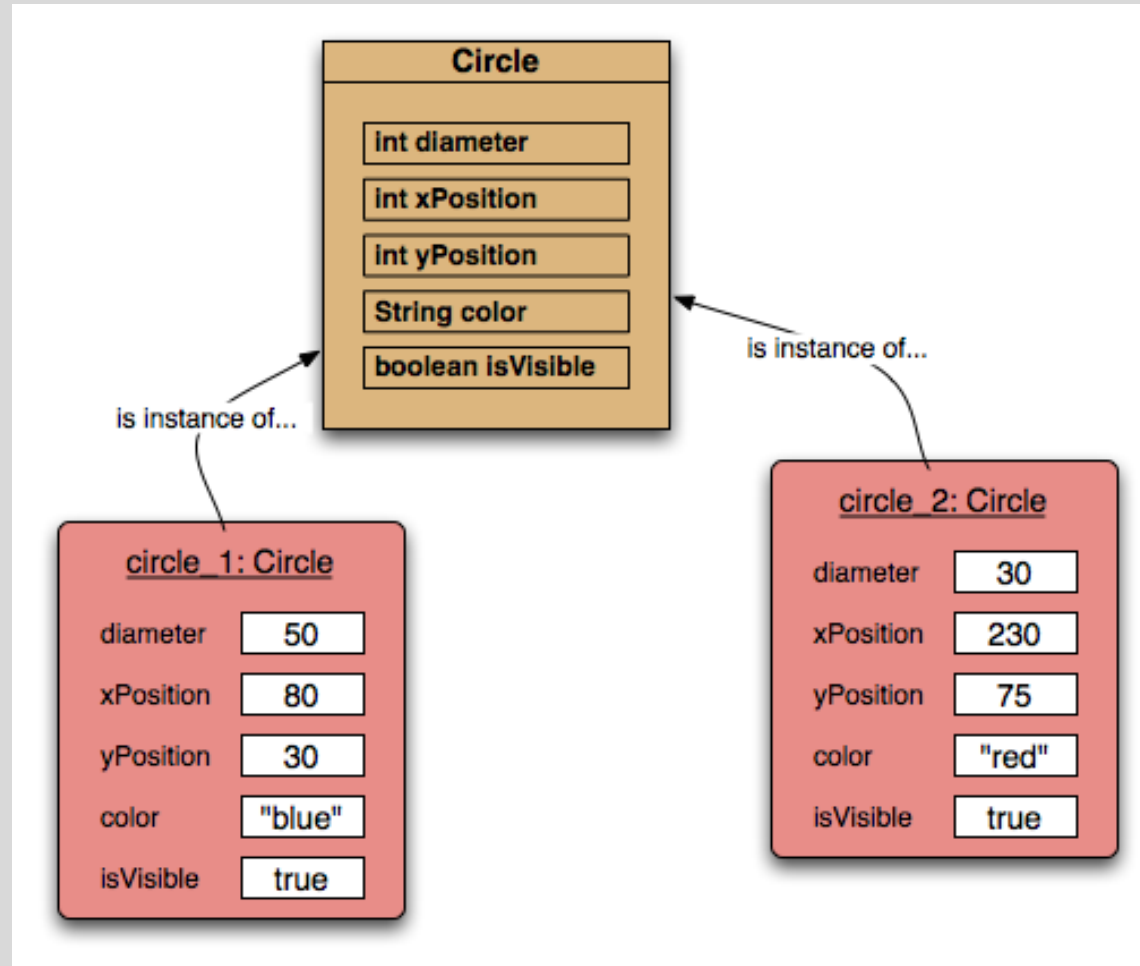
Inspect

Get

Show static fields

Close

Two Circle objects



Source code

- Each class has source code associated with it that defines its details (attributes and methods).
- The source code is written to obey the rules of a particular programming language.

Return values

- All the methods in the *figures* project have **void** return types; but ...
- ... methods may return a result via a return value.
- Such methods have a non-**void** return type.
- More on this later..

Review

- Classes model concepts.
- Source code realises those concepts.
- Source code defines
 - What objects can do (methods).
 - What data they store (attributes).
- Objects come into existence with pre-defined attribute values.
- The methods determine what objects do with their data.

Review

- When a method is called an object:
 - Alters its state, and/or
 - Uses its data to decide what to do.
- Some methods take parameters that affect their actions.
- Methods without parameters typically use their state to decide what to do.
- Some methods return a value.

Review

- Most programs contain multiple classes.
- At runtime, objects interact with each other to realize the overall purpose of the program.

Questions?

